

## The Wish

- Understanding the text

\* Answer the following questions.

a) What did the child do to the ~~so~~ scab on his knee?

Ans. The child kept picking at the scab on his knee, showing his natural curiosity and impatience. Even though it hurt, he was fascinated by it and wanted to explore what was happening to his body. This action reflects the innocence of childhood and how children often learn by touching and playing with things around them, even if it causes discomfort or harm.

b) What kind of effect did the carpet have on the child?

Ans. The carpet made the child feel uneasy and scared because of its strange black patterns. These patterns looked like dangerous holes or traps, making the carpet seem alive and threatening to him. The effect was to make the child cautious and nervous while walking on it. This shows how a child's imagination can turn normal, everyday objects into something frightening and full of mystery.

c) What was he afraid of while walking across the carpet?

Ans. The child was afraid of the black patterns on the carpet because they looked like deep holes or dark shadows where he might fall or get trapped. His imagination made these patterns appear dangerous, even though they were just designs. He worried about slipping or losing his balance while stepping on them. This fear shows how children often turn ordinary things into scary obstacles because their minds create stories around what they see, making the carpet seem like a risky and frightening path to cross in imagination.

d) What motivated and encouraged the child to start and continue on his journey?

Ans. The child was motivated by curiosity and the exciting hope of receiving a puppy for his birthday. Even though he felt scared of the black patterns on the carpet, the thought of the puppy encouraged him to keep going. His desire to explore and reach his goal gave him courage. This shows how children's hopes and dreams help them overcome fear and face challenges with bravery and determination.

e) What did the child see as he looked down on the black patterns of the carpet?

Ans. As the child looked down at the black patterns on the carpet, he saw ~~them~~ many huge snakes which ~~seems~~ stirred at him and seems like if they were going to touch him. His imagination made these patterns appear dangerous, even though they were just designs. ~~He~~ To him, the carpet wasn't just a floor but a tricky path full of obstacles he had to avoid. His imagination made the patterns seem mysterious and frightening, turning a simple carpet into an exciting and challenging adventure in his mind.

- Reference to the Content

a) The writer creates two voices in the story. Who are they?

Ans. The writer creates two distinct voices in the story: the narrator's voice and the child's voice. The narrator speaks in a calm and clean manner, explaining the events in a straightforward way. This voice gives readers an objective understanding of the situation.

In contrast, the child's voice is imaginative and emotional. The child sees the carpet as a dangerous place filled with poisonous snakes and fire. This voice shows the child's

fears, hopes, and curiosity, making the story vivid and engaging.

By using both voices, the writer offers readers two perspectives - an adult's clear explanation and a child's lively imagination - making the story richer and more relatable.

b. Read the extracts given below and answer the questions that follow.

i) What does "the black part" mean?

Ans. The 'black parts' refer to the black patterns on the carpet. The child imagines these dark shapes as poisonous snakes like adders and cobras. To him, these parts look dangerous and scary.

ii) Who is the speaker?

Ans. The speaker is the child in the story. He is imagining the carpet as a dangerous place full of snakes. His voice shows his fear and imagination as he talks about being bitten or burnt.

iii) Why doesn't the speaker want to be burnt?

Ans. The child doesn't want to be burnt because he thinks the red parts of the carpet are like fire that can hurt him. He wants to cross safely to avoid pain and reach his goal of getting a puppy for his birthday.

c) Which images and metaphors are used in the story?

Ans Imagery in the story creates vivid and powerful pictures in the reader's mind. Descriptions like the "hard brown scab" and the "little circle of smooth red skin" make us feel the child's injury clearly. The "enormous red and black and yellow carpet" and "colours spring out in a dazzling way" help us imagine the bright and bold carpet that seems alive.

Metaphors are literary devices characterized by comparison using concept 'as' and 'like'. Calling the carpet a "vast tapestry of color and death" makes it a battlefield of beauty and danger. Saying 'the black parts are snakes' turns the carpet patterns into threatening creatures. The 'big safe island of yellow' shows a place of safety amid danger, while the scab represents healing and protection.

Together, these images and metaphors show the child's imagination and fears, making an ordinary scene into an adventurous and emotional experience. They help readers connect with the child's feelings and see the world through his eyes.

Q) Summarise the short story "The wish" in about 200 words.

Ans. "The Wish" is a story about a young boy who sees his carpet as a dangerous place full of poisonous snakes and burning hot spots. The black patterns on the carpet look like thick snakes, and the red parts appear like lumps of hot coal. The child feels scared but is determined to cross the carpet safely.

The child's imagination turns a simple carpet into a challenging adventure. He fears being bitten by snakes or burnt by fire but is motivated by the hope of receiving a puppy for his birthday. The story shows how children's minds create exciting and frightening worlds out of ordinary things.

The story is told through two voices: the calm narrator who explains events clearly, and the child who expresses fear, hope, and curiosity. This gives readers both an adult's understanding and a child's emotional experience. Overall, "The Wish" explores childhood imagination, courage, and the way children face their fear with hope.

e) The story shows the events through the eyes of the narrator and the child. Comparing the two styles, who presents more interesting or effective view for the readers? Why?

Ans. The child's voice presents a more interesting and effective view for readers because it brings the story to life with emotions and imagination. The child's thoughts show fear, hope, and curiosity, making the story vivid and relatable. Readers can connect with the child's feelings and see the world through his eyes.

In contrast, the narrator's voice is calm and clear but more distant. It explains events logically but lacks the emotional depth that draws readers in. The narrator provides background and context but doesn't capture the child's excitement or fear.

By combining both voices, the story balances clear understanding with emotional experience. However, the child's imaginative and emotional perspective is more engaging because it reveals the inner world of childhood and makes the story memorable and interesting.

f) Is "The Wish" a story about self-confidence overcoming fear or about greed? Give your arguments.

Ans. "The Wish" is primarily a story about self-confidence overcoming fear. The child is afraid of the carpet because of his imagination, but he wants to cross it bravely. His courage grows as he faces the dangerous "snakes" and "fire" imagined on the carpet. This shows how children develop confidence by facing their fears.

The story is not about greed. While the child hopes to get a puppy as a reward, his main focus is on conquering the scary carpet. The puppy is a motivation, not the cause of selfishness or greed.

Overall, the story highlights bravery, imagination, and hope. It teaches readers how fear can be overcome with courage, and how children's minds turn everyday things into adventures they must face and win.